

25STCV14516 25STCV14516

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BACKGROUND

This case is an employment matter. Plaintiff Jessica Gonzales was an employee at a downtown Los Angeles Bar, Precinct. While employed at the bar, Plaintiff alleges she was subjected to a series of unlawful discrimination, harassment, assault, and retaliation. Plaintiff also alleges she was constructively terminated from her position after complaining about these unlawful practices.

On January 12, 2026, Plaintiff filed her second-amended complaint against Defendants BLT Night Life, LLC, Brian McIntire, Jeremy Lucido, and Jeremy Vera. Plaintiff alleges sixteen causes of action stemming from the facts alleged above.

On June 26, 2026, Defendant BLT Night Life, LLC filed a Motion to Compel Further Responses to Form Interrogatories, Set One.

On July 15, 2026, Plaintiff filed an opposition.

On July 21, 2026, Defendant filed a reply.

TENTATIVE RULING

Defendant's Motion to Compel Further Discovery Responses is DENIED as moot.

The Court will not issue sanctions.

LEGAL STANDARD

A.

Interrogatories

Code of Civil Procedure

Section 2030.220, states:

(a) Each answer in a response to interrogatories shall be as complete and straightforward as the information reasonably available to the responding party permits.

(b) If an interrogatory cannot be answered completely, it shall be answered to the extent possible.

(c) If the responding party does not have personal knowledge sufficient to respond fully to an interrogatory, that party shall so state, but shall make a reasonable and good faith effort to obtain the information by inquiry to other natural persons or organizations, except where the information is equally available to the propounding party.

(Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.220.)

Under Code of Civil

Procedure section 2030.300, subdivision (a), the Court may order a responding party to serve a further response to interrogatories if any of the following apply: (1) the answer to a particular interrogatory is incomplete or evasive; (2) the exercise of the option to produce documents is unwarranted or the required specification of those documents is improper or inadequate; or (3) that an objection to an interrogatory is without merit or too general.

A motion to compel further

responses must be accompanied by a meet and confer declaration (See Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (b)(1).) Said declaration must demonstrate a “reasonable and good faith attempt, either in person, by telephone, or by videoconference, to informally resolve each issue presented by the motion.” (Code Civ. Proc., §

2016.040, subd. (a).)

Code of Civil Procedure

section 2030.300, subdivision (d), authorizes a mandatory issuance of sanctions against “any party, person, or attorney who unsuccessfully makes or opposes a motion to compel a further response to interrogatories, unless it finds that the one subject to the sanction acted with substantial justification or that other circumstances make the imposition of the sanction unjust.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (d).)

DISCUSSION

I.

Meet
and Confer

Here, parties’ counsel communicated with one another regarding Plaintiff’s discovery responses. (See Chan Decl., ¶¶ 5-8, 10, 12, 14.) Despite this letter, the parties never met and conferred in person, by telephone, or by video conference. (See *ibid.*) Thus, the meet and confer requirement has not been satisfied. (See Code Civ. Proc., § 2030.300, subd. (b)(1); Code Civ. Proc., § 2016.040, subd. (a).) In addition, Plaintiff provided supplemental responses that apparently addressed all issues but one prior to the filing of this motion. Rather than follow up with an effort to meet and confer further on the one remaining issue, Defendant filed this motion.

Despite Defendant’s failure to satisfy the meet and confer requirement, the Court will still consider the merits of this Motion.

II.

Plaintiff’s
Response to Form Interrogatory No. 6.7

Defendant sought to compel Plaintiff’s further response to Form Interrogatory No. 6.7, which requested Plaintiff furnish the physical address of Dr. Liset Salcedo. After this Motion was filed, Plaintiff served a further supplemental response stating that Dr. Salcedo’s physical address was unknown. (See Plaintiff’s Separate Statement, p.

3:24-27.) In reply, Defendant does not dispute the sufficiency of Plaintiff's supplemental response. (See generally Reply.) The Court finds that the underlying discovery dispute has been resolved. Therefore, the only remaining dispute is whether sanctions are warranted.

Plaintiff contends that

sanctions are not warranted because Defendant failed to meet and confer after she served her third supplemental responses on June 12, 2026. (See Opp'n, pp. 6:14-7:1.) Defendant argues that it had previously met and conferred with Plaintiff on multiple occasions regarding her insufficient responses, even including Form Interrogatory No. 6.7. (See Chan Decl., ¶¶ 5-8, 10, 12, 14.) Therefore, Defendant asserts it had already given her plenty of opportunities to provide sufficient responses.

Plaintiff also contends

that sanctions are not warranted because her supplemental responses were not evasive; they were reasonable, justified, and based on the truth. (See Opp'n, p. 8:3-11.) Considering all of the circumstances, the Court finds that imposing sanctions under the circumstances of this motion would be unjust. In addition, the Court finds the time claimed by defense counsel of over nine hours spent on the motion and reply to be unreasonable. The motion is over one interrogatory and counsel for Defendant knew that Plaintiff did not have the information sought. While Defendant was entitled to a verified response confirming this fact, the motion and associated request for sanctions is excessive. Given these considerations, the Court will not impose sanctions.

CONCLUSION

For the foregoing reasons,

Defendant's Motion to Compel Further Discovery Responses is DENIED as moot.

No sanctions are
ordered.